CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL FULL-YEAR PAPER SET 3

Full Syllabus (Chapters 1–15) | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 3 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 80**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–20 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 21–26 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 27–32 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 33–38 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 31–32 and Q. 36–38.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 20 × 1 = 20

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which is an example of the judiciary protecting minority rights? 1

(a) enforcing equality and religious freedom **(b)** collecting taxes
(c) running schools **(d)** passing laws

2. What principle underlies the policy of scholarships for girls from poor families? 1

(a) taxation **(b)** trade
(c) equity and promoting equal opportunity **(d)** punishment

3. Which combination describes Stage 2? 1

(a) high birth, high death **(b)** low birth, high death
(c) low birth, low death **(d)** high birth, falling death

4. What does regular review of Singapore's master plan show? 1

(a) plans are old **(b)** plans never change
(c) planning must adapt to change **(d)** plans are secret

5. A Mughal garden with water channels and four sections shows 1

(a) stupa design **(b)** shikhara design
(c) gopuram design **(d)** charbagh planning

6. A mine is legal and affordable but the local tribe holds the hill sacred. This is a clash of 1

(a) two renewable resources
(b) economic feasibility with cultural acceptability
(c) technology with rainfall
(d) no conditions

7. A coin of base metal is declared equal to a silver coin. After some months silver coins disappear from the market. This is explained by 1

(a) silver becoming cheap
(b) trade rising
(c) royal gift
(d) people hoarding silver and forging copies

8. If an official's post is hereditary, the likely risk to the ruler is 1

(a) growth of independent power **(b)** lower taxes
(c) more trade **(d)** faster travel

9. A ruler dies with no natural son but has adopted one. Under Lapse the British would 1

(a) recognise the heir **(b)** give gold
(c) annex the state **(d)** leave it

10. In a constituency, Candidate A gets 12,000 votes, B 11,500 and C 9,500. Under FPTP the winner is 1

(a) B **(b)** C
(c) A **(d)** A and B together, as a tie

11. Source: 'The Council of Ministers shall be collectively responsible to the House of the People.' The principle states that 1

(a) judges decide **(b)** each acts alone
(c) ministers sink or swim together **(d)** President rules

12. A potter buys an electric wheel to double output. This shows 1

(a) land rise **(b)** wages fall
(c) rent **(d)** capital substituting labour

13. A student says Greenland is as large as Africa. Her mistake is 1

(a) measuring distance **(b)** reading a globe
(c) trusting a Mercator map's size **(d)** reading the key

14. Which feature made the Swadeshi movement different from earlier protests? 1

(a) It ended taxes
(b) It was violent
(c) It was foreign led
(d) It combined boycott with positive building of Indian enterprises

15. Which clue best suggests that Harappans valued public hygiene? 1

(a) large forts **(b)** wide roads
(c) coins **(d)** covered drains along streets

16. A letter from a prisoner is treated as a petition by a court. This is an example of 1

(a) PIL **(b)** tribunal **(c)** appeal **(d)** arbitration

17. **Assertion (A):** The Indian National Congress was founded in 1885. 1
Reason (R): Its first session was held at Bombay under the presidency of Womesh Chunder Bonnerjee.
Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

18. **Assertion (A):** Most Harappan cities were built of baked bricks. 1
Reason (R): Clay was plentiful on the alluvial plains where they stood.
Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

19. **Assertion (A):** Procedural justice is concerned with the fairness of the process by which a decision is reached. 1
Reason (R): In such a process each side must get a chance to be heard.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

20. **Assertion (A):** Indian citizenship cannot be bought. 1
Reason (R): The Citizenship Act, 1955 lays down how citizenship is acquired or lost.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 6 × 2 = 12

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

21. Why is the sex ratio not just a numeric ratio? 2

22. Find the density if a city of 5,00,000 lives in 100 sq km. 2

23. Why is 'syncretism' a useful term for this period? 2

24. How is value addition an answer to the resource curse? 2

25. What does Krishnadevaraya's Amuktamalyada tell us about him? 2

26. What does the Treaty of Purandar tell us about Shivaji's leadership? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 6 × 3 = 18

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

27. Case: A temple has a chariot design and records the king's victories. Explain what this tells about the age. 3

28. Analyse why the Marathas could not hold north India after Panipat. 3

29. Compare the strategies of Dupleix and Clive. 3

30. Evaluate the importance of the Model Code of Conduct during a state election. 3

31. Analyse the role of the Speaker as a neutral umpire. 3

OR

Explain how the same land may yield different rent in a town and a village. 3

32. Compare the Alps and the Himalaya. 3

OR

Evaluate: 'Revolutionaries and Gandhians had different methods but shared a goal'. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 6 × 5 = 30

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

33. **Case study.** Meera turned 18 and received her voter identity card. In her constituency, ten candidates contested; the one with the highest number of votes won, even though she got less than half of the total votes. Before the election the Election Commission enforced the Model Code of Conduct on all parties. — 5

(i) What is the minimum voting age in India?
(ii) Which body organises the elections?
(iii) Name the system under which the candidate with the most votes wins.
(iv) Why is the Model Code of Conduct important?

34. **Case study.** A Bill on free education for children was passed by the Lok Sabha and then by the Rajya Sabha. It became the Right to Education Act, 2009, after receiving assent. The Act has its roots in the Directive Principles of the Constitution. — 5

(i) Whose assent is needed for a Bill to become law after both Houses pass it?
(ii) Which Directive Principle idea is the source of this Act?
(iii) Which House alone can have a Money Bill introduced?
(iv) Why does a Bill have to be debated in both Houses?

35. Discuss how citizens can make Parliament more effective. — 5

36. Source: COVID-19 broke supply chains. Analyse causes, effects and measures to make supply chains resilient. — 5

OR

Examine how landforms influence settlement, trade and civilisation, using the Nile, European Plain and Andes. — 5

37. Analyse the human cost of Partition and lessons for today. — 5

OR

Compare the contributions of Akbar and Shah Jahan to architecture. — 5

38. Analyse the relationship between the judiciary, legislature and executive. — 5

OR

Evaluate the extent to which Fundamental Duties can be implemented. — 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 80 Marks

MASTERMIND